



In elite company: Aussie quick Spencer Johnson joins a Gujarat Titans attack featuring Mohammed Shami and Rashid Khan as the franchise looks to make a third straight IPL final in 2024. GETTY IMAGES

SPENCER JOHNSON HAS GONE FROM A BIG BASH LEAGUE DEBUT IN JANUARY TO NEARLY BEING A MULTI-MILLIONAIRE WITHIN 12 MONTHS

initial interest from the Mumbai Indians and Delhi Capitals, Starc's bidding price soared from a base of Rs 2 crore to Rs 10 crore, and eventually, KKR secured the landmark deal, surpassing Gujarat Titans' quarter-billion bid.

Cummins: Australia's captain is quite close to 'completing' cricket. With ODI World Cup and WTC titles and an Ashes retention under his belt in the last six months, Cummins went further up on the sport's hot property charts with the maiden Rs 20 crore bid before compatriot Starc overhauled him. The IPL inventory says that he can tonk Jasprit Bumrah for four sixes in an over, hit one of the quickest fifties in 14 balls, and is a tad mercurial with the ball but a nagging presence for batters.

Combined with a coalescence of his leadership and cricketing nous, Cummins received intense bidding from three title-winning IPL sides: MI, Chennai Super Kings, SunRisers Hyderabad, and Royal Challengers Bangalore. SRH's bidding began at the Rs 8 crore mark, four times his base price, before catapulting Cummins onto uncharted shores at Rs 20.5 crore.

Daryl Mitchell: Yet to establish his spot as a true-blue T20I all-rounder, Daryl Mitchell received a whopping Rs 14 crore contract from CSK. Mitchell was among the most successful batters (552 runs) in the recent ODI World Cup, including two hundreds against host India. While at it, the 32-year-old also displayed a penchant for breaking down spin attacks and waging lone battles, a favourite trait in MS Dhoni-territory. "In Chepauk, we can